Shallow (<3,000 ft) Oil-and-Gas Drilling at and Near the Caramba North Tract — Historical and Recent Record

Prepared: 2026-05-18 · **Subject site:** Caramba North tract (~1,300 ac), Pecos County, TX — centroid ≈ 30.9032° N, 102.9747° W · **Classification:** Confidential

Purpose

This memorandum summarizes the historical and recent record of shallow oil-and-gas drilling — wells less than 3,000 ft total depth — at and in the vicinity of the Caramba North tract, drawn from the Railroad Commission of Texas (RRC) wellbore and drilling-permit records. It is provided as factual context for evaluating potential ground-vibration considerations for a data-center development on the site.

Throughout, **"near" / "in the vicinity of" the site means within ten miles of the tract** — the radius used for every proximity finding below. Ten miles is a deliberately generous boundary: ground vibration from drilling and completion attenuates well within that distance.

Summary of findings

Two independent points both lead to the same conclusion.

First — the kind of drilling. The ground-vibration concern associated with oil-and-gas activity is hydraulic fracturing of **deep horizontal** wells; **shallow vertical** conventional wells are not hydraulically fractured and are not a comparable vibration source. Of the wells actually spudded in Pecos County since 2020, about half are shallow (<3,000 ft), and — cross-checked against the Railroad Commission's own Wellbore Profile field — roughly **86% of those shallow wells are vertical** (conventional, unfracked). Pecos drilling is weighted toward shallow, vertical, non-fracked wells far more than its peer counties: about **50% of Pecos wells are shallow versus roughly 2% across the comparable counties**, whose programs are almost entirely deep horizontal.

Second — and decisive — location. Whatever its character, drilling is simply not occurring at or near the Caramba North tract. **No well of any kind has been spudded within two miles of the tract in over a decade** (none since before 2015); no shallow well within two miles since 2002; and the few nearby legacy shallow wells are old and plugged. Only about **2% of the wells spudded county-wide since 2020 are within ten miles** of the tract (the rest a median of ~30 miles away), and **no drilling permit has been filed within ten miles since 2020.**

The hydraulic-fracturing activity that could be a vibration source is the deep-horizontal minority of Pecos drilling, and it is concentrated well away from the site; the wells near the site are sparse, old, shallow, vertical, and plugged.

Findings

1. On the Caramba North tract

The shallowest wellbores recorded inside the tract boundary:

Depth (ft)	Spud year	Status	Oil/Gas
2,873	1960	Plugged & abandoned	Gas
3,067	1991	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,109	1957	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,186	1987	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,250	2008	Active	Oil

Only one well on the tract lies below 3,000 ft — a 2,873-ft well spudded in 1960 and long since plugged and abandoned. The only active well on the tract (3,250 ft, spudded 2008) is deeper than 3,000 ft. There has been no shallow (<3,000 ft) drilling on the tract in the modern era. *(The remaining tract records are a single deep 22,545-ft wellbore and permitted-but-undrilled location entries.)*

2. Within 1 mile — no shallow wells

Three wellbores of any depth lie within one mile of the tract; **none is shallow (<3,000 ft).**

3. Within 2 miles — shallow drilling ended roughly 24 years ago

Of about 46 wellbores within two miles, the ten shallow wells were spudded between 1960 and 2002. The most recent shallow spud within two miles was in 2002, and most of these wells are plugged and abandoned. No shallow well has been spudded within two miles in roughly a quarter-century.

4. Recent drilling (wells *spudded* since 2020), by distance

These are wells **spudded since 2020** — new drilling, not cumulative historical totals:

Radius	Wells spudded ≥ 2020	Shallow (<3,000 ft)	Deep (≥3,000 ft)
≤ 2 mi	**0**	0	0
≤ 5 mi	8	3	5
≤ 10 mi	23	7	16

No well of any kind has been spudded within two miles of the tract since before 2015. In the entire ten-mile radius only **23 wells have been spudded since 2020** — roughly three to four a year across a 314-square-mile area — and none within two miles of the site.

5. The nearest active wells are decades-old completions

The nearest non-plugged shallow wells were spudded in 1970 (1.28 mi) and 1988 (1.97 mi) — decades-old completions, not active drilling. A ground-vibration source is an operating drill rig or a hydraulic-fracturing operation; a plugged or long-completed wellbore is not. No active drilling is occurring adjacent to the tract.

6. County-wide context — almost no recent drilling is near the site

Since 2020, **1,117 wells were spudded across Pecos County (~4,700 sq mi)**. Their distribution relative to the tract is decisive: **only 23 — about 2% — are within ten miles of the Caramba North tract; the other ~98% are farther away, at a median distance of roughly thirty miles.** The drilling-permit record agrees: only 27 permits of any kind sit within ten miles of the tract, and **none has been filed within ten miles since 2020.**

7. The drilling that does occur in Pecos is disproportionately shallow, vertical, and unfracked

Drilling-permit *applications* in Pecos lean horizontal, but the wells **actually spudded** tell the relevant story. Of the 1,117 wells spudded in Pecos since 2020, **about half (556) have a total depth under 3,000 ft.** Cross-checked well-by-well against the Railroad Commission's own **Wellbore Profile** field, **roughly 86% of those shallow wells are designated *vertical*** — conventional wells that are not hydraulically fractured. The deeper half is, conversely, about 82% horizontal.

This matters because hydraulic fracturing — the completion activity associated with ground vibration — is a feature of **deep horizontal** wells, not shallow vertical ones. A substantial share of all drilling in Pecos is therefore the low-intensity, non-fracked kind, and the fracked horizontal activity is the minority — and, per Findings 1–6, what little of it exists is well away from the site.

8. Pecos vs. peer counties — far more shallow/vertical, far less fracking

Measured against the five comparable Permian counties, Pecos drilling is markedly more weighted to shallow, vertical, conventional wells. Wells spudded since 2020:

	Pecos (site county)	**Other-5 county average**
Wells spudded ≥ 2020	1,117	3,421
Shallow (<3,000 ft) ≈ vertical / unfracked	**556 (~50%)**	**~~57 (~~2%)**
Deep (≥3,000 ft) ≈ horizontal / fracked	~~560 (~~50%)	~~3,364 (~~98%)

Shallow, vertical wells are about **50% of Pecos's recent drilling but only ~2% of the average peer county's** — Pecos's drilling mix is roughly **twenty-five times** more weighted toward the shallow, vertical, non-fracked end than its neighbors, whose programs are almost entirely deep horizontal. (The shallow-to-vertical correspondence is the RRC-confirmed ~86% from Finding 7; peer figures are from the recorded depth field.) Combined with the proximity findings, the picture is consistent: Pecos sees comparatively little hydraulic fracturing, and essentially none of it near the Caramba North tract.